clans so that their men could ride on forays with the army.' This gives us a hint that perhaps tax was taken by force and not paid on a written assessment.

Accordingly, Babur decided to levy 30,000 donkey-loads of grain on Kābul, Ghaznī without having any clue about the magnitude of the harvests. What is interesting is that Babur himself acknowledges that this tax impost was unwarranted and eventually caused the Kābulis to suffer.

One thing that must not be missed is that it was during this period that Babur devised his own *Bāburī* script.[*] [†]

## Babur Raids Hazāra

Sulṭān Mas'ūdī Hazāras was designated to pay a large tribute in form of horses and sheep. But when Babur sent his men to collect them, instead of tributes, the news arrived that the Hazāras were obstinate and in no mood to pay up. They had taken up the Ghaznī and Gīrdīz roads against Babur's sanctions. They denied recognizing Babur as the legitimate sovereign.

Babur decided to march along with his strong horsemen to crush this rebellion. He thought the attack would be a surprise as they would not be expecting it, and he would end up being successful in gaining the tributes. Riding by the Maidān road, Babur and his men crossed the Nirkh pass[2] in the night. They finally caught the rebelling Hazaras near Jāl-tū around the time of morning prayers. Though the Hazaras fought well, Babur came on them heavily. They had to bend and agree to what Babur wanted them to pay.

After defeating them, Babur returned through Sang-i-sūrākh and Jahāngīr Mīrzā took leave for Ghaznī. As Babur reached Kābul, Yār-i-ḥusain, son of Daryā Khān, came in from Bhīra, waiting on him.

## The First Campaign for Hindustan

Some days had passed since they returned to Kābul after having crushed the Hazaras.

> *Author's Opinion: Babur wasn't feeling gratified with having attained what was there so far. Perhaps he always had this dream of re-establishing the legacy of Timur in Bharat. And Timur always desired to establish the rule of Islam in Bharat by hook or crook.*[*]

Babur had readied the army once again. He was up to something really big. The people who were acquainted with the length and breadths of Kābul were summoned. They were tasked with sharing every detail of each side and quarter